Ans : (a) Fly ash is used in the manufacture of building materials and in construction activity like the replacement of cement in concrete. It contains trace levels of toxic elements (e.g. arsenic barium beryllium, boron, cadmium, Chromium, Thallium, Selenium, Molybdenum and mercury).

75. Which one of the following is associated with the issue of control and phasing out of the use of ozone-depleting substances?
(a) Bretton Woods Conference
(b) Montreal Protocol
(c) Kyoto Protocol
(d) Nagoya Protocol

Ans : (b) Montreal Protocol on substances that Deplete the Ozone layer (a protocol to the Vienna Convention for the protection of the Ozone Layer) is an international treaty designed to protect the Ozone layer by phasing out the production of numerous substances that are responsible for Ozone depletion.

76. What is Rio+20 Conference, often mentioned in the news?
(a) It is the United Nations Conference on Sustainable Development
(b) It is a Ministerial Meeting of the World Trade Organization
(c) It is a Conference of the Inter-governmental Panel on Climate Change
(d) It is a Conference of the Member Countries of the Convention on Biological Diversity

Ans : (a) The United Nation Conference on Sustainable Development or Rio+20 took place in Rio-de-Janeiro, Brazil, on 20-22 June 2012. It resulted in a focused political outcome document which contains clear and practical measure for implementing sustainable development.

77. Which of the following statements regarding 'Green Climate Fund' is/are correct?
1. It is intended to assist the developing countries in adaptation and mitigation practices to counter climate change.
2. It is founded under the aegis of UNEP, OECD, Asian Development Bank and World Bank.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (a) The fund is governed by the GCF Board. GCF is currently structured into two themes- mitigation and adaptation.
GCF is a fund within the framework of UNFCCC.

78. The term 'IndARC', sometimes seen in the news, is the name of
(a) an indigenously developed radar system inducted into Indian Defence
(b) India's satellite to provide services to the countries of Indian Ocean Rim
(c) a scientific establishment set up by India in Antarctic region
(d) India's underwater observatory to scientifically study the Arctic region

Ans : (d) The deployment of IndARC, the country's first underwater moored observatory in the Kongsfjorden Fjord, halfway between Norway and the North pole, represents a major milestone in India's scientific endeavours in the Arctic region. The observatory is anchored at a depth of 192 m and has an array of 10 states of the art oceanographic sensors strategically positioned at various depths in the water.

79. In a particular region in India, the local people train the roots of living trees into robust bridges across the streams. As the time passes, these bridges become stronger. These unique `living root bridges' are found in–
(a) Meghalaya (b) Himachal Pradesh
(c) Jharkhand (d) Tamil Nadu

Ans : (a) Meghalaya's double- decker and single-decker root bridges are unique in the world and are a sight to behold. The bridges are tangles of massive thick roots, which have been intermingled to form a bridge that can hold several people at a time. Khasi people have been trained to grow their bridges across the raised banks of streams to form a solid bridge made from roots. The living bridges are made from the roots of the Ficus Elastica tree, which produces a sense of secondary roots that are perched atop huge boulders along the streams or the river banks to form bridges.

80. Which one of the following is the best description of the term ecosystem'?
(a) A community of organisms interacting with one another
(b) That part of the Earth which is inhabited by living organisms
(c) A community of organisms together with the environment in which they live
(d) The flora and fauna of a geographical area

Ans : (c) Ecosystem is a community of living organisms in conjunction with the non-living components of their environment interacting as a system. The ecosystem varies greatly in size from a small pond to a large forest or a Sea. Many ecologists regard the entire biosphere as a global ecosystem as a composite of all local ecosystems on Earth. It can be divided into two basic categories, namely the terrestrial and the aquatic. Forest, grassland and desert are some examples of terrestrial ecosystems, while pond, lake, wetland, river and estuary are some examples of the aquatic ecosystems.

81. Which of the following has/have been accorded 'Geographical Indication' status?
1. Banaras Brocades and Sarees
2. Rajasthani Daal-Bati-Churma
3. Tirupathi Laddu

Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (c) Banaras Brocades Sarees and Tirupati laddu has been accorded Geographical Indication status.
- Banaras Brocades Sarees are among the first Sarees in India and are known for their gold and silver brocade on zari fine silk and opulent embroidery.
- Rajasthani Daal- Bati- churma is a popular dish of Rajasthan, also popular in Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh.
- Tirupati Laddu or Srivari Laddu is the laddu sweet offered as Navivedhyam to Venkateswara at Tirumala Venkateswara temple in Tirupati, Chitoor district, Andhra Pradesh.

CURRENT AFFAIRS

82. The 'Fortaleza Declaration', recently in the news, is related to the affairs of–
(a) ASEAN (b) BRICS
(c) OECD (d) WTO

Ans : (b) The 6th BRICS Summit was held in Fortaleza (Brazil). The Theme of the Summit was Inclusive Growth-sustainable solutions. The participating nations Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa jointly issued the Fortaleza Declaration.
The 13th BRICS summit was held under India's chairship on 09 september 2021. It was the third time that India hosted the BRICS summit after 2012 & 2016.

83. Among the following, which were frequently mentioned in the news for the outbreak of Ebola virus recently?
(a) Syria and Jordan
(b) Guinea, Sierra Leone and Liberia
(c) Philippines and Papua New Guinea
(d) Jamaica, Haiti and Surinam

Ans : (b) Ebola virus causing hemorrhagic fever was detected on 23rd March, 2014 in Guinea. More than 80 persons have been detected to have been infected with the Ebola virus. Out of this 59 people from Sierra Leone and Liberia have died. This marks the first time an outbreak among humans has been detected.

84. In the context of modern scientific research, consider the following statements about 'IceCube', a particle detector located at South Pole, which was recently in the news :
1. It is the world's largest neutrino detector, encompassing a cubic kilometre of ice.
2. It is a powerful telescope to search for dark matter.
3. It is buried deep in the ice.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (d) The Ice Cube Neutrino Observatory is a neutrino telescope built at the South Pole of Antarctica. The project is being developed, operated and managed by the University of Wisconsin, Madison. According to the announcement made in November 2013, 28 neutrinos were discovered by this telescope.
It is buried beneath the surface, extending to a depth of about 2500 meters; burying it deep in ice is important to enhance the precision of the detector.

85. The terms 'Agreement on Agriculture', 'Agreement on the Application of Sanitary and Phytosanitary Measures' and `Peace Clause' appear in the news frequently in the context of the affairs of the
(a) Food and Agriculture Organization
(b) United Nations Framework Conference on Climate Change
(c) World Trade Organization
(d) United Nations Environment Programme

Ans : (c) The terms "Agreement on Agriculture", " Agreement on the application of Sanitary and Phytosanitary Measures" and "peace clause", we hear in the context of the affairs of the World Trade Organisation.

86. The area known as 'Golan Heights' sometimes appears in the news in the context of the events related to
(a) Central Asia (b) Middle East
(c) South-East Asia (d) Central Africa

Ans : (b) The Golan heights are a rocky plateau in western Asia that was captured by Israel from Syria in the 1967 six-day war. The international community recognizes the Golan heights to be official Syrian territory and widely rejects the Israel military occupation
'Golan Heights' is a disputed region between Israel and Syria, which was captured by Israel in 1981 from Syria.

87. Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament and Development for 2014 was given to which one of the following?
(a) Bhabha Atomic Research Centre
(b) Indian Institute of Science
(c) Indian Space Research Organization
(d) Tata Institute of Fundamental Research

Ans : (c) A jury chaired by Vice President Hamid Ansari chose ISRO for the award, given to individuals or organisations who promote international development, a new international economic order or make scientific discoveries for the public good.

88. India is a member of which among the following?
1. Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation
2. Association of South-East Asian Nations
3. East Asia Summit

Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3
(d) India is a member of none of them

Ans : (b) India is a member of the East Asia Summit. India is a also a member of ASEAN.
The East Asia Summit (EAS) is a regional forum held annually by leaders of initially countries in the East Asian, Southeast Asian, South Asian and Oceanian regions. The 18 EAS member countries represent collectively 55% of the world population and account for around 55% of global GDP.